






EPCH
Export Promotion Council for Handicrafts
Connecting. Empowering. Transforming.

EPCH AIMS AT TRIPLING HANDICRAFTS EXPORTS BY 2030

Teen Guna Tees Tak!

India's rich cultural diversity also encompasses its unique and exquisite range of handicrafts, a traditional legacy passed down generations, which serve as icons of the geographies they belong to. In the year 1986-87, the unorganised, community-based handicraft initiatives was brought under the Export Promotion Council for Handicrafts (EPCH), with the objective to promote, support and maintain international product quality standards by connecting, empowering and transforming the lives of artisans by creating a vibrant ecosystem to boost exports, manifold.

Excellence is the hallmark of EPCH, New Delhi, which has a membership of Handicraft exporter of around 10,000 from PAN India. The apex organisation focuses on improving infrastructure, marketing and information to support Indian handicraft to achieve its ambitious handicrafts export target of 'Teen Guna Tees Tak' - Tripling Exports by 2030. Emphasis is on emerging trends and design intervention in product development, packaging innovation, brand building, enhance productivity, quality and standards, sustainable development, and compliances, offering Indian handicrafts a level playing field in a sharply competitive global market.

One of EPCH's flagship initiatives include organizing international trade fairs and exhibitions. The Indian Handicrafts and Gifts Fair (IHGF Delhi Fair), a biannual, is among the world's largest and most prestigious trade fairs, which attracts over 3,000 Indian exhibitors and thousands of international trade buyers and visitors from across the globe. IHGF is recognised by Limca Book of Records as the largest congregation of handicrafts exporters under one roof. EPCH also participates in more than 30 major international fairs for showcasing India's indigenous handicrafts. The EPCH's commitment can be gauged from the handicrafts exports during FY 2023-24, which stood at a whopping Rs. 32,759 Crores and US $ 3,956 million!

The Council has regional offices in Agra, Bangalore, Guwahati, Jaipur, Jodhpur, Kolkata, Moradabad, Mumbai, Saharanpur and Narsapur. EPCH has been instrumental in setting up State of the Art exhibition complex i.e. India Expo Centre & Mart at Greater Noida, Delhi –NCR. EPCH has Common Facility Centre at Saharanpur, Resource Centre at Moradabad and Trade Facilitation Centre at Jodhpur. The International Lace Trade Centre with dyeing facility at Narsapur (Andhra Pradesh), the Handicraft Productivity Centre at Jaipur, with a Wood testing lab, and the Pashmina Certification Centre at Dehradun set-up in collaboration with Wildlife Institute of India (WII), Dehradun, are among EPCH's path-breaking efforts. EPCH developed Vriksh, Indian timber legality, assessment and verification standards and shipment certifications for facilitating exports of wooden handicrafts made of Dalbergia sisoo and Dalbergia latifolia and is acceptable by 184 CITES, signatory countries. The scheme is confirmed to 10 Sustainable Development Goals (SDGs) of UNFCC.

Entrepreneurs have access to various training and capacity building programmes run by the Council in the areas of compliance, policy interventions, packaging, marketing strategies, design trends and forecast. Providing a comprehensive and integrated approach to build an enabling and transformative ecosystem, initiatives such as the EPCH Design connect portal, Design Clinic services EPCH Design Register, Handicrafts & Carpet Sector Skill Council (HCSSC), and EPCH Centre for Handicrafts Exports Management Studies (CHEMS), are among the sustainable and consistent initiatives in the last 4 decades to empower export capabilities and global acceptability of products of Indian artisans and entrepreneurs.

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